

THE JP MOVEMENT & THE EMERGENCY

THE 1972-73 ECONOMIC CRISIS – NAV NIRMAN AND THE – THE RAILWAY STRIKE, MAY – THE ALLAHABAD HIGH COURT – THE SUPREME COURT’S CONDITIONAL – THE PROCLAMATION: DATED 25

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

THE 1972-73 ECONOMIC CRISIS

THE 1972-73 ECONOMIC CRISIS

TWIN MONSOON FAILURES + 1973 OIL SHOCK

DEEPENING SCARCITY

PRICE RISE

ABOUT 22 PER CENT OVER 1972-73

INFLATION, UNEMPLOYMENT, FOOD SCARCITY ERODE INDIRA GANDHI'S POPULARITY

FOLLOWS DIRECTLY ON THE 1971 GARIBI HATAO LANDSLIDE

CORE CLAIM

TWIN MONSOON FAILURES + 1973 OIL SHOCK → deepening scarcity

PRICE RISE → about 22 per cent over 1972-73

MECHANISM

EFFECT → inflation, unemployment, food scarcity erode Indira Gandhi's popularity

TIMING → follows directly on the 1971 Garibi Hatao landslide

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

TWIN MONSOON FAILURES + 1973 OIL SHOCK → deepening scarcity

PRICE RISE → about 22 per cent over 1972-73

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TIMING → follows directly on the 1971 Garibi Hatao landslide.

01

STAGE 01

NAV NIRMAN AND THE BIHAR MOVEMENT, 1974

NAV NIRMAN AND THE BIHAR MOVEMENT, 1974

NAV NIRMAN

GUJARAT, JANUARY 1974: STUDENTS PROTEST PRICES AND CORRUPTION

BIHAR MOVEMENT

MARCH 1974: JP TAKES LEADERSHIP

JP'S CALL

"TOTAL REVOLUTION"

SAMPOORNA KRANTI

NAV NIRMAN → Gujarat, JANUARY 1974; students protest prices and corruption

BIHAR MOVEMENT → MARCH 1974; JP takes leadership

JP'S CALL → "Total Revolution" / Sampoorna Kranti

SPREAD → student unrest becomes a nationwide anti-government movement

CORE CLAIM

NAV NIRMAN → Gujarat, JANUARY 1974; students protest prices and corruption

BIHAR MOVEMENT → MARCH 1974; JP takes leadership

MECHANISM

JP'S CALL → "Total Revolution" / Sampoorna Kranti

SPREAD → student unrest becomes a nationwide anti-government movement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

NAV NIRMAN → Gujarat, JANUARY 1974; students protest prices and corruption

BIHAR MOVEMENT → MARCH 1974; JP takes leadership

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SPREAD → student unrest becomes a nationwide anti-government movement.

02

STAGE 02

THE RAILWAY STRIKE, MAY 1974

THE RAILWAY STRIKE, MAY 1974

ALL-INDIA RAILWAY STRIKE

MAY 1974, LASTING 22 DAYS

DIRECT CHALLENGE

TO THE GOVERNMENT'S AUTHORITY

ADDED DIMENSION

ECONOMIC DISRUPTION LAYERED ONTO THE POLITICAL CRISIS

DEEPENS THE CRISIS JP'S MOVEMENT WAS ALREADY BUILDING ON

ALL-INDIA RAILWAY STRIKE → MAY 1974, lasting 22 days

DIRECT CHALLENGE → to the government's authority

ADDED DIMENSION → economic disruption layered onto the political crisis

CONTEXT → deepens the crisis JP's movement was already building on

CORE CLAIM

ALL-INDIA RAILWAY STRIKE → MAY 1974, lasting 22 days

DIRECT CHALLENGE → to the government's authority

MECHANISM

ADDED DIMENSION → economic disruption layered onto the political crisis

CONTEXT → deepens the crisis JP's movement was already building on

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

ALL-INDIA RAILWAY STRIKE → MAY 1974, lasting 22 days

DIRECT CHALLENGE → to the government's authority

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONTEXT → deepens the crisis JP's movement was already building on.

03

STAGE 03

THE ALLAHABAD HIGH COURT JUDGMENT, 12 JUNE 1975

THE ALLAHABAD HIGH COURT JUDGMENT, 12 JUNE 1975

RAJ NARAIN

JUSTICE JAGMOHANLAL SINHA, ALLAHABAD HIGH COURT

12 JUNE 1975

SETS ASIDE INDIRA GANDHI'S 1971 ELECTION ON ELECTORAL MALPRACTICE

PETITIONER → Raj Narain

JUDGE → Justice Jagmohanlal Sinha, Allahabad High Court

DATE → 12 JUNE 1975

RULING → sets aside Indira Gandhi's 1971 election on electoral malpractice

CORE CLAIM

PETITIONER → Raj Narain

JUDGE → Justice Jagmohanlal Sinha, Allahabad High Court

MECHANISM

DATE → 12 JUNE 1975

RULING → sets aside Indira Gandhi's 1971 election on electoral malpractice

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

PETITIONER → Raj Narain

JUDGE → Justice Jagmohanlal Sinha, Allahabad High Court

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULING → sets aside Indira Gandhi's 1971 election on electoral malpractice.

04

STAGE 04

THE SUPREME COURT'S CONDITIONAL STAY, 24 JUNE 1975

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SUPREME COURT, JUSTICE V.R. KRISHNA IYER

24 JUNE 1975

CONDITIONAL STAY OF THE ALLAHABAD VERDICT

INDIRA GANDHI REMAINS PRIME MINISTER WHILE THE APPEAL IS

COURT → Supreme Court, Justice V.R. Krishna Iyer

DATE → 24 JUNE 1975

RULING → CONDITIONAL stay of the Allahabad verdict

EFFECT → Indira Gandhi remains Prime Minister while the appeal is pending

CORE CLAIM

COURT → Supreme Court, Justice V.R. Krishna Iyer

DATE → 24 JUNE 1975

MECHANISM

RULING → CONDITIONAL stay of the Allahabad verdict

EFFECT → Indira Gandhi remains Prime Minister while the appeal is pending

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

COURT → Supreme Court, Justice V.R. Krishna Iyer

DATE → 24 JUNE 1975

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULING → CONDITIONAL stay of the Allahabad verdict.

05

STAGE 05

THE PROCLAMATION: DATED 25 JUNE, ANNOUNCED 26 JUNE

THE PROCLAMATION

DATED 25 JUNE, ANNOUNCED 26 JUNE

JP'S DELHI RALLY

25 JUNE 1975; CALLS FOR CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE

ARTICLE 352, DATED 25 JUNE 1975

PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT

ONLY ON 26 JUNE 1975

THE TWO DATES MUST NEVER BE COLLAPSED INTO ONE

JP'S DELHI RALLY → 25 JUNE 1975; calls for civil disobedience

PROCLAMATION → Article 352, DATED 25 JUNE 1975

PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT → only on 26 JUNE 1975

TRAP → the two dates must never be collapsed into one

CORE CLAIM

JP'S DELHI RALLY → 25 JUNE 1975; calls for civil disobedience

PROCLAMATION → Article 352, DATED 25 JUNE 1975

MECHANISM

PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT → only on 26 JUNE 1975

TRAP → the two dates must never be collapsed into one

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

JP'S DELHI RALLY → 25 JUNE 1975; calls for civil disobedience

PROCLAMATION → Article 352, DATED 25 JUNE 1975

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → the two dates must never be collapsed into one.

06

STAGE 06

INSTRUMENTS OF THE EMERGENCY: MISA, CENSORSHIP, 42ND AMENDMENT

INSTRUMENTS OF THE EMERGENCY

MISA, CENSORSHIP, 42ND AMENDMENT

UNDER MISA; OVER 100,000 HELD WITHOUT TRIAL, ~19 MONTHS

CENSORSHIP IMPOSED

CONSTITUTIONAL CHANGE

42ND AMENDMENT, 1976: EXPANDS CENTRAL/EXECUTIVE POWER

TWENTY-POINT PROGRAMME, 1 JULY 1975

DETENTIONS → under MISA; over 100,000 held without trial, ~19 months

PRESS → censorship imposed

CONSTITUTIONAL CHANGE → 42nd Amendment, 1976; expands central/executive power

AGENDA → Twenty-Point Programme, 1 July 1975

CORE CLAIM

DETENTIONS → under MISA; over 100,000 held without trial, ~19 months

PRESS → censorship imposed

MECHANISM

CONSTITUTIONAL CHANGE → 42nd Amendment, 1976; expands central/executive power

AGENDA → Twenty-Point Programme, 1 July 1975

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

DETENTIONS → under MISA; over 100,000 held without trial, ~19 months

PRESS → censorship imposed

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONSTITUTIONAL CHANGE → 42nd Amendment, 1976; expands central/executive power.

07

STAGE 07

SANJAY GANDHI'S EXTRA-CONSTITUTIONAL POWER AND ITS EXCESSES

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NO FORMAL OFFICE, EXTRA-CONSTITUTIONAL POWER CENTRE

HIS OWN FOUR-POINT PROGRAMME, 1976

COMPULSORY STERILISATION DRIVES

SLUM-DEMOLITION DRIVES

CORE CLAIM

POSITION → no formal office; extra-constitutional power centre

PROGRAMME → his own four-point programme, 1976

MECHANISM

EXCESSES → compulsory sterilisation drives

EXCESSES → slum-demolition drives

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

POSITION → no formal office; extra-constitutional power centre

PROGRAMME → his own four-point programme, 1976

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: POSITION → no formal office; extra-constitutional power centre.

08

STAGE 08

1977: THE ELECTORAL REVERSAL

THE ELECTORAL REVERSAL

ELECTIONS CALLED

JANUARY 1977

ELECTIONS HELD

MARCH 1977

CONGRESS AND SANJAY GANDHI DEFEATED

A VERDICT FOR CIVIL LIBERTIES; ENDS THE EMERGENCY

ELECTIONS CALLED → January 1977

ELECTIONS HELD → March 1977

RESULT → Congress and Sanjay Gandhi defeated

MEANING → a verdict FOR civil liberties; ends the Emergency

CORE CLAIM

ELECTIONS CALLED → January 1977

ELECTIONS HELD → March 1977

MECHANISM

RESULT → Congress and Sanjay Gandhi defeated

MEANING → a verdict FOR civil liberties; ends the Emergency

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

ELECTIONS CALLED → January 1977

ELECTIONS HELD → March 1977

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MEANING → a verdict FOR civil liberties; ends the Emergency.

09

STAGE 09

WHAT HELD AND WHAT FAILED

WHAT HELD AND WHAT FAILED

THE ELECTORAL MACHINERY ITSELF; FREE VERDICT DELIVERED IN 1977

PARLIAMENT; FAILED TO CHECK THE EXECUTIVE

THE RULING PARTY; OFFERED NO INTERNAL RESTRAINT

JUDICIARY'S DETENTION JURISPRUDENCE, IN THE MISA CASES

CORE CLAIM

HELD → the electoral machinery itself; free verdict delivered in 1977

FAILED → Parliament; failed to check the executive

MECHANISM

FAILED → the ruling party; offered no internal restraint

FAILED → Judiciary's detention jurisprudence, in the MISA cases

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

HELD → the electoral machinery itself; free verdict delivered in 1977

FAILED → Parliament; failed to check the executive

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HELD → the electoral machinery itself; free verdict delivered in 1977.

10

STAGE 10

THE JP MOVEMENT'S SOCIAL BASE

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STUDENTS, MIDDLE CLASS, TRADERS, INTELLIGENTSIA

NOT THE BASE

RURAL POOR OR THE ORGANISED URBAN WORKING CLASS

MORAL AUTHORITY SUFFICIENT TO DESTABILISE THE GOVERNMENT

NO BASE BROAD ENOUGH TO GOVERN AFTER 1977

BASE → students, middle class, traders, intelligentsia

NOT THE BASE → rural poor or the organised urban working class

STRENGTH → moral authority sufficient to destabilise the government

LIMITATION → no base broad enough to govern after 1977

CORE CLAIM

BASE → students, middle class, traders, intelligentsia

NOT THE BASE → rural poor or the organised urban working class

MECHANISM

STRENGTH → moral authority sufficient to destabilise the government

LIMITATION → no base broad enough to govern after 1977

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

BASE → students, middle class, traders, intelligentsia

NOT THE BASE → rural poor or the organised urban working class

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMITATION → no base broad enough to govern after 1977.

11

STAGE 11

FIFTY YEARS OF THE EMERGENCY, 2025

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UNION CABINET RESOLUTION, 25 JUNE 2025

COMMEMORATES FIFTY YEARS SINCE THE EMERGENCY

HONOURS RESISTANCE; REAFFIRMS CONSTITUTIONAL DEMOCRACY

PIB, PRID 2139543 (NO PUBLIC URL RECORDED BY THE

EVENT → Union Cabinet resolution, 25 JUNE 2025

CONTENT → commemorates fifty years since the Emergency

FRAMING → honours resistance; reaffirms constitutional democracy

SOURCE → PIB, PRID 2139543 (no public URL recorded by the owner)

CORE CLAIM

EVENT → Union Cabinet resolution, 25 JUNE 2025

CONTENT → commemorates fifty years since the Emergency

MECHANISM

FRAMING → honours resistance; reaffirms constitutional democracy

SOURCE → PIB, PRID 2139543 (no public URL recorded by the owner)

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

EVENT → Union Cabinet resolution, 25 JUNE 2025

CONTENT → commemorates fifty years since the Emergency

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOURCE → PIB, PRID 2139543 (no public URL recorded by the owner).

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

CHANDRA'S STRUCTURAL READING

A GENUINE ECONOMIC CRISIS (RECESSION, UNEMPLOYMENT, INFLATION, SCARCITY, OIL

WITH A POLITICAL CRISIS (CONGRESS DECAY, CORRUPTION, DE-INSTITUTIONALISATION) TO

HE IS EVEN-HANDED IN ASSIGNING RESPONSIBILITY

JP'S EXTRA-PARLIAMENTARY MOVEMENT — CALLING ON THE POLICE AND

ARMY TO DISOBEY "ILLEGAL" ORDERS — OPENED THE DOOR

EQUALLY, INDIRA HAD A CONSTITUTIONAL EXIT SHE REFUSED —

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

Chandra's structural reading: a genuine economic crisis (recession, unemployment, inflation, scarcity, oil shock) fused

with a political crisis (Congress decay, corruption, de-institutionalisation) to create a revolutionary situation.

CAUTION: He is even-handed in assigning responsibility: JP's extra-parliamentary movement — calling on the police and

army to disobey "illegal" orders — opened the door to undemocratic, even quasi-fascist, possibilities.

ADVANCED DEBATE

CAUTION: Equally, Indira had a constitutional exit she refused — dissolving the

Lok Sabha and holding early elections — choosing instead an authoritarian remedy.

The Emergency is thus framed as a temporary abnormal expedient that turned draconian, not an inevitability.

The Emergency was initially accepted by many for restoring order, ending strikes,

LEGACY / NUANCE

disciplining smugglers and stabilising prices — under a constitutional, "temporary" framing.

Disillusion grew with censorship, mass arrests (MISA), the 42nd Amendment, Sanjay

Gandhi's extra-constitutional power, and above all coercive sterilisation and slum demolitions.

The 1977 verdict showed that attachment to civil liberties, fundamental rights and

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.